SSC MTS 2023 question paper with answers

14 September 2023 · Shift 2

44 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 46 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20231223070914/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_MTS2023_22122023.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 2 questions

Q.3

By selling an article for ₹5,280, Geeta lost 12%. For what amount should she sell it to make a profit of 12%?

(A) ₹6,820
(B) ₹7,150
(C) ₹5,780
(D) ₹6,720

Q.5

Suresh could save 20% of his income. But 4 years later, when his income increased by 40%, he could save the same amount only as before. By how much percentage did his expenditure increase?

(A) 23%
(B) 50%
(C) 22%
(D) 45%

General Awareness 18 questions

Q.1

Swami Dayanand Saraswati founded a reform organisation in 1875 that attempted to reform Hinduism. What was it called?

(A) Arya Samaj
(B) Prarthna Samaj
(C) Satyashodhak Samaj
(D) Brahmo Samaj

Q.2

The Brihadeswara Temple at Tanjavur built by:

(A) Rajaraja II
(B) Samudragupta
(C) Rajendra Chola
(D) Rajaraja I

Q.4

What is the minimum voting age for the citizens of India?

(A) 18 years
(B) 21 years
(C) 30 years
(D) 25 years

Q.7

The four Nattuvanars namely Ponaiyah, Vadivelu, Sivanandam and Chinnaiya, who are renowned as Tanjaore Bandhu shaped up the modern day _____.

(A) Bharatanatyam
(B) Kuchipudi
(C) Kodiattam
(D) Kathakali

Q.8

In February 2023, Uttar Pradesh government launched a/an _____ called Family ID-One Family One Identity.

(A) Portal
(B) News letter
(C) WhatsApp Group
(D) Email Id

Q.10

Why are intermediate goods NOT included in the calculation of national income?

(A) Including intermediate goods would result in double counting.
(B) Intermediate goods are not produced within the country's borders.
(C) Including intermediate goods would decrease the value of national income.
(D) Intermediate goods are not important for measuring economic activity.

Q.11

According to the Global Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI) 2021,India's rank is _____ out of 109 countries.

(A) 66th
(B) 71st
(C) 59th
(D) 63rd

Q.13

What is the main purpose of a bank statement?

(A) To track income and expenses
(B) To transfer funds to another account
(C) To advertise new banking products
(D) To have locker facility in the bank

Q.14

The Konark Dance Festival (KDF) has been held at Konark since 1986 between _____ every year.

(A) 1st and 5th October
(B) 1st and 5th August
(C) 1st and 5th January
(D) 1st and 5th December

Q.15

Identify the southernmost range of the Himalaya from the following.

(A) Shiwaliks Range
(B) Trans Himalaya Range
(C) Lesser Himalaya Range
(D) Greater Himalaya Range

Q.18

The novel 'Train to Pakistan' was written by _____.

(A) Khushwant Singh
(B) Nawaz Sharif
(C) Zakir Hussain
(D) Imran Khan

Q.19

Popular Bollywood actor Kriti Sanon is a trained _____ dancer.

(A) Kuchipudi
(B) Kathak
(C) Odissi
(D) Bharatanatyam

Q.20

In which of the following cities was the final match of the 2022 Vijay Hazare Trophy held?

(A) Ahmedabad
(B) Raipur
(C) Lucknow
(D) Ranchi

Q.21
Who started the chemical revolution in the 18th century by naming oxygen and helping to organize chemical nomenclature?

(A) Dame Kathleen Lonsdale
(B) Svante August Arrhenius
(C) Joseph Priestley
(D) Antoine-Laurent Lavoisier

Q.22
Aman Sehrawat became the first Indian to win a gold medal in World Wrestling Championship in which category?

(A) U-15
(B) U-20
(C) U-23
(D) U-25

Q.23
Independence Day is celebrated every year in Pakistan on _____.

(A) 30 January
(B) 14 August
(C) 31 December
(D) 23 March

Q.24
Which of the following Indian musicians was called 'Mallika-e-Ghazal'?

(A) Prabha Bharti
(B) Begum Akhtar
(C) Chitra Singh
(D) Farida Khanum

Q.25
The word 'yorker' is related to which sport?

(A) Kho Kho
(B) Cricket
(C) Basketball
(D) Kabaddi

English Language and Comprehension 24 questions

Q.1
Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. I wish we had _____ come here.

(A) right
(B) clear
(C) never
(D) agreed

Q.2
Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Carnal

(A) Material
(B) Spiritual
(C) Temporal
(D) Somatic

Q.3
Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Fail to function normally

(A) Maltreat
(B) Mangle
(C) Manipulate
(D) Malfunction

Q.4
Select the most appropriate meaning of the given phrase. All of a sudden

(A) Intentionally
(B) Quickly and unexpectedly
(C) Quickly and Expectedly
(D) Accidently

Q.5

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. My daughter was / invited to lunch / hosted by the Governor / at his residence.

(A) at his residence
(B) invited to lunch
(C) hosted by the Governor
(D) My daughter was

Q.6

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Resist
(B) Rectifie
(C) Recruit
(D) Repulse

Q.7

Select the option that rectifies the spelling of the underlined word in the given sentence. The “maintenence” department did a fabulous job.

(A) mainteanance
(B) maintenance
(C) maintenannce
(D) meintenance

Q.8

Select the most appropriate synonym of the bracketed word in the following sentence to fill in the blank. The novel’s intricate plot and rich character development kept readers _____(committed) from the beginning to the end.

(A) engaged
(B) secluded
(C) detached
(D) dismantled

Q.9

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom. These things are very “hard to swallow”.

(A) difficult to resist
(B) difficult to speak
(C) difficult to believe
(D) difficult to eat

Q.10

Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank. The decision to go on a trip after my vacations was the _____.

(A) ice on the cake
(B) icing on the cake
(C) apple on the cake
(D) icing on the brownie

Q.11

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. The new software / consists from / several features / and tools.

(A) consists from
(B) several features
(C) and tools
(D) The new software

Q.12

Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank. It's easy to say that you'll start exercising every day, but it is _____.

(A) like fish out of water
(B) easier said than done
(C) crying wolf
(D) going the extra mile

Q.14

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the word given in brackets to fill in the blank. Uncle Joe is _____(reputable) for spending 10 years of his youth in prison due to armed robbery.

(A) mournful
(B) anxious
(C) well-known
(D) notorious

Q.15

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. If you work hard, you secure good marks.

(A) good marks
(B) If you
(C) work hard
(D) you secure

Q.16

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A person who is skilled in making maps

(A) Calligrapher
(B) Curator
(C) Cacographer
(D) Cartographer

Q.17

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the underlined group of words. Sita loves her “glass container in which she has many fish.”

(A) aquarium
(B) cannister
(C) planetarium
(D) museum

Q.18

Select the most appropriate option that can rectify the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to rectify it, select ‘no rectification needed’. His claim to be the “smartly” kid in the school was a bit hyperbole!

(A) no rectification needed
(B) smartest
(C) smarter
(D) smart

Q.19

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Easily set on fire

(A) Innocuous
(B) Ingrained
(C) Inflammable
(D) Inimical

Q.20

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains an error. She has / bought / a car / two years ago.

(A) She has
(B) bought
(C) two years ago
(D) a car

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Students put their heart and soul into studies while (1)_____ for examinations. They prepare the syllabus by giving many revisions, making important points on flash cards, preparing notes throughout the year. They read reference books in order to score good marks in the examination. This is the demanding (2)_____ of all the students who are appearing in the examinations. But, most students feel tensed on the day before an examination. Everyone is in a state of (3)_____ as to what questions would be asked in the paper and whether they could write their answers properly to get good marks. Such overthinking is the cause of (4)_____ which definitely affects their performance. They should revise the subject regularly and should not keep their doubts pending. This will not create a (5)_____ of backlog and they will get sufficient time to resolve their problem.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) calculating
(B) guiding
(C) producing
(D) preparing

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Students put their heart and soul into studies while (1)_____ for examinations. They prepare the syllabus by giving many revisions, making important points on flash cards, preparing notes throughout the year. They read reference books in order to score good marks in the examination. This is the demanding (2)_____ of all the students who are appearing in the examinations. But, most students feel tensed on the day before an examination. Everyone is in a state of (3)_____ as to what questions would be asked in the paper and whether they could write their answers properly to get good marks. Such overthinking is the cause of (4)_____ which definitely affects their performance. They should revise the subject regularly and should not keep their doubts pending. This will not create a (5)_____ of backlog and they will get sufficient time to resolve their problem.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) principle
(B) method
(C) routine
(D) habit

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Students put their heart and soul into studies while (1)_____ for examinations. They prepare the syllabus by giving many revisions, making important points on flash cards, preparing notes throughout the year. They read reference books in order to score good marks in the examination. This is the demanding (2)_____ of all the students who are appearing in the examinations. But, most students feel tensed on the day before an examination. Everyone is in a state of (3)_____ as to what questions would be asked in the paper and whether they could write their answers properly to get good marks. Such overthinking is the cause of (4)_____ which definitely affects their performance. They should revise the subject regularly and should not keep their doubts pending. This will not create a (5)_____ of backlog and they will get sufficient time to resolve their problem.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) confidence
(B) hesitation
(C) assurance
(D) uncertainty

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Students put their heart and soul into studies while (1)_____ for examinations. They prepare the syllabus by giving many revisions, making important points on flash cards, preparing notes throughout the year. They read reference books in order to score good marks in the examination. This is the demanding (2)_____ of all the students who are appearing in the examinations. But, most students feel tensed on the day before an examination. Everyone is in a state of (3)_____ as to what questions would be asked in the paper and whether they could write their answers properly to get good marks. Such overthinking is the cause of (4)_____ which definitely affects their performance. They should revise the subject regularly and should not keep their doubts pending. This will not create a (5)_____ of backlog and they will get sufficient time to resolve their problem.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) anxiety
(B) agitation
(C) peace
(D) comfort

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Students put their heart and soul into studies while (1)_____ for examinations. They prepare the syllabus by giving many revisions, making important points on flash cards, preparing notes throughout the year. They read reference books in order to score good marks in the examination. This is the demanding (2)_____ of all the students who are appearing in the examinations. But, most students feel tensed on the day before an examination. Everyone is in a state of (3)_____ as to what questions would be asked in the paper and whether they could write their answers properly to get good marks. Such overthinking is the cause of (4)_____ which definitely affects their performance. They should revise the subject regularly and should not keep their doubts pending. This will not create a (5)_____ of backlog and they will get sufficient time to resolve their problem.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) burden
(B) mass
(C) weight
(D) power

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.3 **(D)** Q.5 **(B)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**
Q.11 **(A)**	Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(B)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(B)**

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(C)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(A)**

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.3 · Answer (D) ₹6,720

A 12% loss means ₹5,280 is 88% of the cost price, so CP = 5,280/0.88 = ₹6,000. A 12% profit needs 1.12 × 6,000 = ₹6,720.

Q.5 · Answer (B) 50%

Take the income as 100: saving 20, expenditure 80. The new income is 140 and the saving still 20, so expenditure is 120, a rise of 40/80 = 50%.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) Arya Samaj

Swami Dayanand Saraswati founded the Arya Samaj at Bombay in 1875; it called for a return to the Vedas. The Prarthana Samaj was founded by Atmaram Pandurang, the Satyashodhak Samaj by Jyotirao Phule and the Brahmo Samaj by Raja Ram Mohan Roy.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Rajaraja I

The Brihadeeswara temple at Thanjavur, Tamil Nadu, was built by the Chola king Rajaraja I and completed in about 1010 AD.

Q.4 · Answer (A) 18 years

Under Article 326, as amended by the 61st Amendment (1988), every citizen aged 18 or over may vote; the age was 21 before.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Bharatanatyam

The Tanjore Quartet, the brothers Chinnaiya, Ponnaiya, Sivanandam and Vadivelu at the Thanjavur court in the early 19th century, set the order of items of the Bharatanatyam recital that is still followed.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Portal

In February 2023 Uttar Pradesh opened the portal for its 'Family ID - One Family One Identity' scheme: for families with a National Food Security ration card the ration card number serves as the Family ID, and other families apply on the portal for a 12-digit Family ID.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Including intermediate goods would result in double counting.

Intermediate goods are used up in making final goods, so their value is already included in the value of the final goods; counting them again would count the same output twice.

Q.11 · Answer (A) 66th

In the Global MPI 2021, released by UNDP and the Oxford Poverty and Human Development Initiative in October 2021 and covering 109 countries, India was placed 66th.

Q.13 · Answer (A) To track income and expenses

A bank statement lists every deposit, withdrawal and charge on an account over a period, with the balance, so the holder can keep track of money coming in and going out.

Q.14 · Answer (D) 1st and 5th December

The Konark Dance Festival is held every year from 1 to 5 December at the open-air auditorium near the Sun Temple, Konark.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Shiwaliks Range

The Shiwaliks, the Outer Himalayas, are the southernmost of the ranges; to their north lie the Lesser Himalaya (Himachal) and the Greater Himalaya (Himadri), and the Trans Himalaya lies beyond.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Khushwant Singh

Khushwant Singh's 'Train to Pakistan' (1956) is set in a Punjab border village during the Partition of 1947.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Kathak
The actor Kriti Sanon is a trained Kathak dancer and has learnt the classical dance of north India since childhood.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Ahmedabad
The final of the 2022-23 Vijay Hazare Trophy was played at the Narendra Modi Stadium, Ahmedabad, on 2 December 2022; Saurashtra beat Maharashtra by five wickets.

Q.21 · Answer (D) Antoine-Laurent Lavoisier
Antoine Lavoisier named oxygen and hydrogen, explained combustion as a reaction with oxygen, and with others drew up a system of chemical names (1787). Priestley isolated oxygen but called it 'dephlogisticated air'.

Q.22 · Answer (C) U-23
At Pontevedra, Spain, in October 2022, Aman Sehrawat won the 57 kg freestyle title at the U-23 World Wrestling Championships, the first Indian to win gold at that event.

Q.23 · Answer (B) 14 August
Pakistan celebrates its Independence Day on 14 August, the day before India's. 23 March is Pakistan Day, marking the Lahore Resolution of 1940.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Begum Akhtar
Begum Akhtar, the singer of ghazal, dadra and thumri, was called 'Mallika-e-Ghazal', the queen of ghazal.

Q.25 · Answer (B) Cricket
In cricket a yorker is a ball pitched at or near the batter's feet, hard to hit.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (C) never
'I wish' with the past perfect expresses regret about the past: 'I wish we had never come here.' The other words do not fit between 'had' and 'come'.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Spiritual
'Carnal' means of the body and its desires; its opposite is 'spiritual'. 'Material', 'temporal' and 'somatic' are close to it in meaning.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Malfunction
To 'malfunction' is to fail to work normally. To maltreat is to treat cruelly, to mangle is to crush out of shape, and to manipulate is to control cleverly or unfairly.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Quickly and unexpectedly
'All of a sudden' means suddenly: quickly and unexpectedly.

Q.5 · Answer (B) invited to lunch
The name of a meal takes no article in general ('invited to lunch'), but a particular meal, here the one hosted by the Governor, takes one: 'invited to a lunch hosted by the Governor'.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Rectifie
The correct spelling is 'rectify'.

Q.7 · Answer (B) maintenance
The correct spelling is 'maintenance'.

Q.8 · Answer (A) engaged
Readers 'committed' to a book are held by it: 'engaged'. 'Secluded', 'detached' and 'dismantled' do not fit.

Q.9 · Answer (C) difficult to believe
Something 'hard to swallow' is difficult to believe or accept.

Q.10 · Answer (B) icing on the cake
'The icing on the cake' is something good added to what is already good, here the trip after the vacations.

Q.11 · Answer (A) consists from
'Consist' takes 'of': 'The new software consists of several features and tools.'

Q.12 · Answer (B) easier said than done
'Easier said than done' describes something that is easy to talk about but hard to do, such as exercising every day.

Q.14 · Answer (D) notorious
'Reputable' means well thought of; 'notorious' means famous for something bad, as Uncle Joe is for his armed robbery.

Q.15 · Answer (D) you secure
SSC's key gives 'you secure': a condition about a likely future result takes 'will' in the main clause, 'If you work hard, you will secure good marks.' (The simple present is also used for general truths, but the textbook rule expects 'will' here, and no other part has an error.)

Q.16 · Answer (D) Cartographer
A 'cartographer' makes maps. A calligrapher writes decoratively, a curator looks after a museum's collection, and a cacographer writes or spells badly.

Q.17 · Answer (A) aquarium
An 'aquarium' is a glass tank in which fish and other water creatures are kept.

Q.18 · Answer (B) smartest
Comparing him with every kid in the school needs the superlative of the adjective: 'the smartest kid in the school'. 'Smartly' is an adverb.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Inflammable
'Inflammable' (like 'flammable') means easily set on fire. Innocuous means harmless, ingrained deep-rooted and inimical hostile.

Q.20 · Answer (A) She has
The present perfect is not used with a definite past time such as 'two years ago': 'She bought a car two years ago.'

Q.21 · Answer (D) preparing
Students study hard while 'preparing' for examinations, which the next sentences describe: revisions, flash cards and notes.

Q.22 · Answer (C) routine
Revising, making flash cards and notes all year make up a 'routine', a regular pattern of work, and a demanding one.

Q.23 · Answer (D) uncertainty
Not knowing what questions will be asked is a state of 'uncertainty'; 'confidence' and 'assurance' contradict the students' tension.

Q.24 · Answer (A) anxiety
Overthinking causes 'anxiety', worry about what is to come, which affects their performance; 'agitation' is outward restlessness, and 'peace' and 'comfort' contradict the sense.

Q.25 · Answer (A) burden
Pending doubts pile up into a 'burden' of backlog, a heavy load of work still to be done.

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